Reforesting the Amazon

Since the 1970s, up to 20 percent of the Amazon rainforest has been lost. At the United Nations Paris Climate Summit in 2015, Brazil pledged to restore nearly 30 million acres (12 million hectares) by the year 2030. In 2017, Conservation International, in partnership with the Brazilian government, launched the area's biggest reforestation program to date, under which Amazonas state will gain 73 million trees through seeding and planting.

Local communities are being enrolled to implement the program, using a technique called *muvuca*. This involves spreading the seeds of more than 200 native forest species over every square yard of land. Less labor-intensive than traditional tree planting, the method can reforest land quickly, delivering around 6,000 plants per acre. In addition to the seeding program some planting will enrich secondary forest and return pasture land to forest.

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